
“The **patriot blood** of my father was **warm in my veins.**”

CLARA BARTON, WRITING OF HER DECISION TO WORK ON THE BATTLEFIELD

Clarissa Harlowe Barton, known as “The Angel of the Battlefield,” was one of the best-known women of the Civil War era, eclipsing other nurses and female wartime reformers through her role as founder and first director of the American Red Cross in the postwar period. Her efforts during the war saved countless lives, and her work on behalf of missing soldiers eased the grief of thousands of loved ones after the war was over.

“... General McClellan ... sinks into insignificance beside the **true heroine** of the age, the **angel of the battlefield.**”

DR. JAMES DUNN, A SURGEON AT ANTIETAM, ON CLARA BARTON, SEPTEMBER 1862

“What could I do but go with them?”

Having worked for several years as a teacher, Barton was working at the Patent Office in Washington at the outbreak of the war in 1861. She quickly recognized that the disorganized and understaffed Federal Medical Department was woefully unprepared for the scale of casualties that the conflict would produce. When Washington